

If you suddenly won \$10 million, would you know what to do with it? Would you know how to spend and save? How to change your tipping habits? How to travel differently, donate money, and navigate tricky family situations with your money?

Of course not.

One reason you wouldn't even know where to start is that you likely don't possess the technical skills to manage wealth at that level, including complex things like trusts, CDARS, and assembling the right financial team. (Don't worry: When the time is right, I can show you how.)

But there'd be something even more fundamental stopping you: your Money Beliefs. Money Beliefs describe the ways you see money; they include how you were raised, who you're surrounded with, and your "mental model" of what money can do for you. To boil it down, if I asked you what money means to you in a single sentence, what would you say? Whether you answered with words like "growth," "safety," or "never enough," *that* is your Money Belief.

Your Money Beliefs shape the way you see the world, as well. Do you think there's always more money to be made or that money is a zero-sum game? Whichever option you believe will profoundly shift your attitudes and behaviors toward money.

The tricky thing about Money Beliefs is that they're not always obvious. Some are out in the open ("I'm scared I won't have enough"). Others are more subtle ("I was taught that in order to make money, it should be difficult"). And many are completely invisible to us, because these beliefs can't be quantified and don't show up on a spreadsheet. It's like the old story about the fish that doesn't know it's swimming in water.

Our Money Beliefs are incredibly influential. If you look around at the room you're sitting in right now and at the clothes you're wearing—really, take a look!—it's likely that one of your Money Beliefs contributed to something within eyesight. Maybe it's the shirt you're wearing ("It's foolish to buy things full price"). Or the living room you're sitting in ("I bought because I don't want to pay a landlord's mortgage").

As your net worth grows, it's important to grow your Money Beliefs too. In my experience, once you understand how money really works—especially the power of compound interest—it becomes fairly straightforward to expand your net worth. As I always say, "It's not magic.